

Diamone Cromer

Syracuse, New York 13210

9/22/26

Erik Ubels

Founder, MetisReal

Netherlands

Dear Mr. Ubels,

I'm writing to invite you to speak at Arup's continuing education series for our Digital Advisory team in Hong Kong. I help coordinate the series as part of my internship here, and your work on The Edge in Amsterdam is exactly the kind of perspective our team is looking for.

Arup's approach, something we call Total Design, treats data and physical design as a single discipline rather than two separate ones. That's the same idea behind The Edge: a building where data wasn't an add-on but the foundation the whole design was built around. I've read some of your writing on taking a pragmatic, step-by-step approach to making existing buildings smart, rather than treating it as an all-or-nothing overhaul, and I think that mindset would resonate strongly with our team, since we often work with existing structures rather than clean-slate designs.

I think your experience leading The Edge, and your current work helping organizations build smart building strategies from the ground up, would give our team a real, practical look at what that philosophy looks like in practice, not just in theory.

We'd like to invite you to speak for about an hour, followed by a question-and-answer session and a short workshop where our team could ask about specific projects they're working on. We can offer a modest honorarium, a round-trip flight, and a one-night hotel stay for your visit. We know your schedule is demanding, so we're glad to work around dates that fit your calendar in the coming months.

Our team works across data, engineering, and design every day, and hearing directly from someone who has actually built a smart building at the scale of The Edge would mean far more to them than another case study. I'd welcome the chance to discuss details further and find a date that works for you.

Sincerely,

Diamone Cromer